Lesson 9

WHO IS THE HOLY SPIRIT - Part 1

Introduction:

Within the Godhead, the identity of the Holy Spirit has been, to a large extent unknown to many Christians. This is perhaps the reason some Christians or churches are not flowing in the life of the Holy Spirit. This study will explore basic aspects of the person of the Holy Spirit.

I. WHO IS THE HOLY SPIRIT?

A. He is the third person in the Godhead.

Matthew 28:19

19 "Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit,"

2 Corinthians 13:14,

14 "May the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with you all."

What is a Godhead?

The term Godhead is found *three times* in the King James Version: Acts 17:29; Romans 1:20; and Colossians 2:9. In each of the three verses, a slightly different Greek word is used, but the *definition of each is the same: "deity" or "divine nature."* ***The word Godhead is used to refer to God's essential nature.***

Acts 17:9 (KJV)

"Forasmuch then as we are the offspring of God, we ought not to think that the Godhead (theion) is like unto gold, or silver, or stone, graven by art and man's device"

Romans 1:20 (KJV)

“The invisible things of him from the creation of the world are clearly seen, being understood by the things that are made, even his eternal power and Godhead (theiotés) so that they are without excuse”

Colossians 2:9

“In him [Christ] dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead (theotés) bodily.”

B. **He is God.**

Acts 5:3,4

3 Then Peter said, "Ananias, how is it that Satan has so filled your heart that you have lied to the Holy Spirit and have kept for yourself some of the money you received for the land? 4 Didn't it belong to you before it was sold? And after it was sold, wasn't the money at your disposal? What made you think of doing such a thing? You have not lied to men but to God."

C. **He is a Person. In what way?**

a. **He has a mind.**

Romans 8:27

27 "And he who searches our hearts knows the mind of the Spirit, because the Spirit intercedes for the saints in accordance with God's will."

1 Cor. 2:11

11 "For who among men knows the thoughts of a man except the man's spirit within him? In the same way no-one knows the thoughts of God except the Spirit of God."

b. **He has a Will.**

John 16:12-15

12 "I have much more to say to you, more than you can now bear. 13 But when he, the Spirit of truth, comes, he will guide you into all the truth. He will not speak on his own; he will speak only what he hears, and he will tell you what is yet to come. 14 He will glorify me because it is from me

that he will receive what he will make known to you. ***15*** *All that belongs to the Father is mine. That is why I said the Spirit will receive from me what he will make known to you."*

1 Cor. 12: 11

11 "All these are the work of one and the same Spirit, and he gives them to each one, just as <u>he determines."</u>

Galatians 5:16-18

*"****16*** *So I say, walk by the Spirit, and you will not gratify the desires of the flesh.* ***17*** *For the flesh desires what is contrary to the Spirit, and the Spirit what is contrary to the flesh. They are in conflict with each other, so that you are not to do whatever[a] you want.* ***18*** *But if you are led by the Spirit, you are not under the law."*

c. **He has emotions.**

Romans 5:5

5 "And hope does not disappoint us, because God has poured out his love into our hearts by the Holy Spirit, whom he has given us."

Eph. 4:30

30 "And do not grieve the Holy Spirit of God, with whom you were sealed for the day of redemption."

Heb. 10:29

29 "How much more severely do you think a man deserves to be punished who has trampled the Son of God under foot, who has treated as an unholy thing the blood of the covenant that sanctified him, and who has insulted the Spirit of grace?"

II. WHAT IS THE FUNCTION OF THE HOLY SPIRIT IN THE GODHEAD?

A. He glorifies The Son

John 16:13,14

13 "But when he, the Spirit of truth, comes, he will guide you into all truth. He will not speak on his own; he will speak only what he hears, and he will tell you what is yet to come. 14 He will bring glory to me by taking from what is mine and making it known to you."

B. He is the active member of the Godhead

Gen. 1:2

"Now the earth was formless and empty, darkness was over the surface of the deep, and the Spirit of God was hovering over the waters."

III. THE WORK OF THE HOLY SPIRIT

A. He convicts and convinces

John 16:7,8 "But I tell you the truth: It is for your good that I am going away. Unless I go away, the Counsellor will not come to you; but if I go, I will send him to you. 8 When he comes, he will convict the world of guilt in regard to sin and righteousness and judgment."

B. He brings life

Titus 3:5 "He saved us, not because of righteous things we had done, but because of his mercy. He saved us through the washing of rebirth and renewal by the Holy Spirit,"

C. **He dwells within the believers**

John 14:16,17 "And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another Counsellor to be with you for ever- 17 the Spirit of truth. The world cannot accept him, because it neither sees him nor knows him. But you know him, for he lives with you and will be in you."

D. **He is the comforter**

John 14:16,17

16 "And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another Counsellor to be with you for ever-17 the Spirit of truth. The world cannot accept him, because it neither sees him nor knows him. But you know him, for he lives with you and will be in you."

E. **He leads us into the truth. John 16:13**

13 But when he comes, the Spirit of truth, he will guide you to all truth. He will not speak on his own, but he will speak what he hears, and will declare to you the things that are coming."

F. **He guides**

Romans 8:14,

14 because those who are led by the Spirit of God are sons of God.

G. **He gives power.**

Acts 1:8

8 “But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you; and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth.”

IV. **Conclusion**

The Holy Spirit is a real person and He is God. He was sent by God the Father to be our comforter and guide. Let us, therefore, recognize His ministry and ask God that the Holy Spirit may dwell in us.

Luke 11:13 “If you then, though you are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give the Holy Spirit to those who ask him!"